



King County Library System

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes

KCLS Service Center/Hybrid | November 19, 2025, 5pm

Present

KCLS Board

Jeffery Guddat
Verna Seal
Lalita Uppala
Laura Valenziano*

KCLS Staff

Maria Bassett
Angie Benedetti
BJ Colvin
Heidi Daniel
Lisa Fraser
Chase Gallagher
Angie Mirafior
Dominica Myers
Danielle Perry
Cecie Streitman
Lisa Yamasaki
Donna Zirkle

**attended remotely*

Motions Approved

1. Board Meeting agenda
2. October 29, 2025 Board meeting minutes
3. Payroll expenditures
4. General Fund expenditures
5. Resolution 2025-03 Property Tax Revenue Increase
6. Resolution 2025-04 Property Tax Levy
7. Resolution 2025-05 Recognition of Lalita Uppala

Call to Order

Secretary Jeff Guddat called the meeting to order at 5:04pm. Verna Seal and Lalita Uppala attended in person; Laura Valenziano attended online. There was a quorum.

Approval of Agenda

Lalita Uppala moved approval of the Board Meeting agenda. Verna Seal seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.

Approval of Board Minutes

Laura Valenziano moved approval of the October 29, 2025 Board Meeting minutes. Lalita Uppala seconded the motion. All voted in favor and the motion passed unanimously.

Public Comment

Patron Helen Stanwell expressed appreciation for the increase in the free printing allowance to \$5 and the return of in-person public budget hearings at community libraries. She also expressed concern that the KCLS budget has grown at a rate disproportionately higher than local inflation.

Finance and Facilities Report

Finance and Facilities Director Donna Zirkle presented the monthly Finance report as of the end of October 2025. Year-to-date (YTD) revenues were \$139.9M, which was approximately 93% of the yearly revenue budget of \$150.6M. YTD expenses were \$124.2M, which is 75% of the total expense budget of \$164.6M. CIP expenses YTD at the end of October were \$6M, accounting for 48% of the total budget of \$12.5M.



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Donna also introduced Resolution 2025-03 Property Tax Increase and 2025-04 Property Tax Levy. She detailed property tax statute RCW 27.12.050, which allows rural library districts to levy residents for library services. She also discussed RCW 84.55, which provides for an annual increase in the allowable property tax levy. Resolution 2025-03 allows for a 1% increase in property tax over 2025; the increase will be from \$140.5M in 2025 to \$141.9M in 2026. Resolution 2025-04 outlines the allowable levies for 2026 which include the base property tax levy (\$141.9M), new construction and tax increment financing (\$1.6M), and prior year refunds (\$0.6M) for a total of \$144.1M.

Donna also explained why the levy rate decreases as property tax amounts increase. Each year, KCLS divides the levy amount above by the assessed property values to come up with the levy rate. The levy rate per \$1,000 assessed value in 2026 will be .237, down from .244 in 2025.

Approval of Monthly Expenditures

Verna Seal moved approval of Payroll expenditures for October in the amount of \$3,595,013.36:

(10/10) Ck#00202551-00202568; 137833836-137834970; (10/21) Ck#142705671; (10/24) Ck#00202569-00202581; 145405762-145406897. **Laura Valenziano seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.**

Lalita Uppala moved approval of General Fund #0010 expenditures for October in the amount of

\$10,021,875.13: Travel Advances – Ck#1561; (10/09) Ck#1162468-1162604; 5015822-5015826 (10/16) Ck#5015827-5015864; 1162605-1162685; (10/23) Ck#5015865-5015869; 1162686-1162831; (10/24) Ck#1162832-1162840; (10/31) Ck#1162841-1162962; 5015870-5015872; (11/06) Ck#5015873-5015876; 1162963-1163076. Voids - 0. **Verna Seal seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.**

Lalita Uppala moved approval of Resolution 2025-03 Property Tax Revenue Increase. Verna Seal seconded. All voted in favor and the motion passed unanimously.

Laura Valenziano moved approval of Resolution 2025-04 Property Tax Levy. Verna Seal seconded. All voted in favor and the motion passed unanimously.

Staff and Director's Reports

Tax Increment Financing

Government Relations Manager John Sheller provided an overview of tax increment financing (TIF), a state-authorized tool for funding public infrastructure projects that aim to stimulate economic development, including jobs and housing. TIFs are available to cities, counties and ports, and are limited in geographic scope, financial amount, and duration.



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John explained the mechanics of TIF: Within the designated area, property values are “frozen” at a base year. Local taxing districts, including KCLS, continue to receive levy revenue based on the frozen value. As property values increase due to development, the city collects the incremental revenue and applies it to the TIF project. A “no harm” provision allows assessors to add an incremental value to the rest of the district to compensate for revenue lost through the frozen valuation. Donna noted that TIF revenue, along with revenue from new construction, contributes a minor but consistent revenue stream for KCLS annually.

KCLS actively participates in a statewide working group of local taxing districts to monitor TIF impacts and to provide feedback on potential legislative adjustments.

John illustrated the discussion with examples of an existing TIF project in Kirkland and a proposed project in Bellevue for 2026. Bellevue has provided preliminary proposals for affected taxing districts and will be asking each district to vote on whether to participate or not. More information and a vote is expected in the first half of 2026.

Director’s Report

Executive Director Heidi Daniel discussed the recent 100th anniversary celebration at the Bellevue Library, which was attended by more than 250 people.

She reviewed several dashboard metrics, all of which are on track. Heidi highlighted digital circulation, which has already surpassed 10 million checkouts this year. She noted that digital circulation is projected to equal or exceed physical circulation by the end of the year.

Written Reports

Jeff Guddat referred the trustees to the written report summarizing the Q&A from the three recent public budget hearings. Laura Valenziano thanked the community libraries that hosted the hearings, noting their important role in supporting a transparent budget process.

Board Committee Reports

Jeff provided an update on the audit process, which began following a risk assessment meeting and a formal entrance meeting with state auditors.

He also briefly reported on the Bellevue Chamber of Commerce Economic Forecast breakfast, which he attended recently with John Sheller and Donna Zirkle.



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Trustees Reports

President Laura Valenziano gave a tribute to Trustee Lalita Uppala as she prepares to retire from the Board of Trustees after serving two full five-year terms (10 years). This is her final meeting. Lalita talked fondly about her time at KCLS.

Laura Valenziano moved approval of Resolution 2025-05 Recognition of Lalita Uppala. Verna Seal seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.

Adjournment

Jeff Guddat adjourned the meeting at 5:53pm.

Laura Valenziano, President

Jeff Guddat, Secretary
